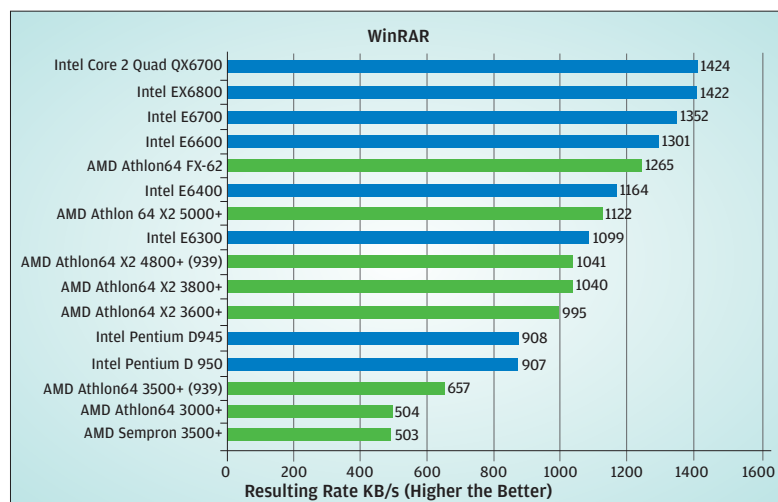
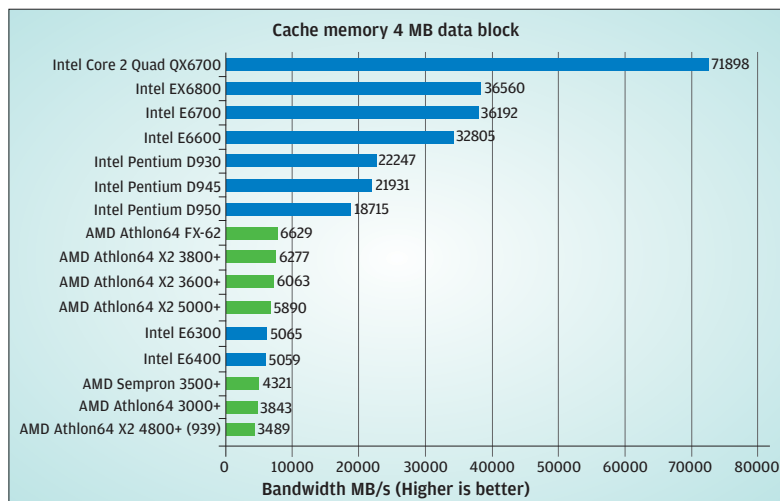


Si Soft Sandra 2007: Cache Memory 4 MB

This graph shows cache performance when a 4 MB data block is used. The results are as expected—larger caches result in better performances. Since the QX6700 has 8 MB of cache, the score is skewed in its favour.



WinRAR 3.6

The Quad Core has the potential to compress more files than the rest in a given time frame, but doesn't leave the EX6800 far enough behind. Processors based on the Core architecture perform commendably better than the rival AMD processors and the older Pentium D series.

Conclusion

In the theoretical benchmarks the AMD processors showed commendable performance in scientific benchmarks, implying good performance under such circumstances. When it comes to pure processing power the Quad Core has lot of horses in reserves and coupled with proper application it can unleash performance of unprecedented levels. The processors based on Core 2 Duo offer the best bang for the buck and have proved themselves across all the benchmarks.



Notes From The Lab

During the test, we came across a few things that we would like to share. Firstly, the blistering performance of the Core processors was a sight to behold—reminiscent of the AMD Athlon's heydays when it zipped through every test we threw at it.

Even today, we get mails about AMD's heating issues; we take this opportunity clear the misconception—there are none! The processors stay cool even at full load. During this test, the Pentium D processors spewed heat like furnaces, causing the cooling fan to run at full speed. The whine from said fan was enough to keep the reviewer very far away from the rig while the tests completed. The Core processors, however, do run cool and the Quad gets a little over normal when fully loaded—that's expected, though.

Intel's cooling solutions used to be a simple task—the fan-heatsink combo provided with older Pentium 4s was quite easy to install and remove. Not anymore! We still have

numb fingers after going through the complex and clumsy installation and removal—a countless number of times during the motherboard and processor test. On the other hand, AMD has made the whole affair simple and painless.

Though we ran the Quad Core through the common test process, it was more an indication of how it fared in today's application scenario when compared to the rest, than of its full performance. Even the standard battery of benchmarks will need revamping for the Quad—explained by the unexpected numbers we saw in some of the tests. We'll be putting it through more punishment in the following months; even now, though, it leaves the competition in the dust. And considering that the Quad might actually launch *cheaper* than the FX-62, we wonder what's going on in the AMD camp as we write this.

It will no doubt be interesting to see how AMD's upcoming Barcelona matches up to this early next year—the architecture, at least, promises to beat the Core.